



The Gentle Starter Locs Checklist

Two practical checklists to support you
before you start and one month in.



Inside this booklet

1. Pre-Starting Locs Checklist
2. Post 1-Month Checklist



Pre-Starting Locs Checklist

Use this checklist before your installation day. Tick each item as you complete it so you feel prepared and calm on the day.

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- ☐ Decide preferred loc size, style, and method (discuss in consultation).
 - ☐ Assess current hair length, density, and health; trim damaged ends if needed.
 - ☐ Clarify the hair thoroughly to remove buildup.
 - ☐ Stop heavy butters, gels with residue, and most leave-ins so the hair is clean.
 - ☐ Consult a locician (especially recommended for first-timers).
 - ☐ Gather a small kit: residue-free shampoo, light oil or rose water for scalp, satin/silk bonnet or pillowcase.
 - ☐ Take clear “before” photos (front, sides, back, close-ups).
 - ☐ Set realistic expectations about the starter stage and the patience required.
 - ☐ Plan the first 2–4 weeks of low-manipulation care.
 - ☐ Mentally prepare for the transition (shedding of loose hair, itching, early appearance).





Post 1-Month Checklist

Around the one-month mark, walk through this list. It helps you notice progress and catch anything that needs attention before your next appointment.

- ☐ Check locking progress (look for early budding or matting).
- ☐ Confirm your washing routine is still on track and scalp feels clean.
- ☐ Inspect parting and tension for any thinning or excessive pulling.
- ☐ Assess moisture balance (hydrated but not greasy).
- ☐ Note any unraveling or sections that need attention at the next appointment.
- ☐ Review sleep protection and daily habits.
- ☐ Take progress photos in similar lighting/angles.
- ☐ Address any persistent itching, odor, excessive shedding, or irritation with your stylist.
- ☐ Confirm current products and routine are still suitable.
- ☐ Plan the next maintenance step (next wash or retie).

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